

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-70: Open schooling for science education and a learning continuum for all

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of between EUR 1.50 and 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 5.50 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

⁹⁴ A model of cooperation between industry, academia, civil society and public authorities, with a strong emphasis on citizens and their needs.

⁹⁵ Including topic SwafS-19-2018-2019-2020.

- Promote creation of new partnerships that foster networking, sharing and applying science and technology research findings amongst teachers, researchers and professionals across different enterprises;
- Engage learners in meaningful real-life problem-solving situations, within education, the workplace and other learning environments;
- Encourage science studies and science careers by supporting cross-community networks of stakeholders to address issues such as the Green Deal, Health and Digitalisation;
- Increase female participation in science studies and science careers and deconstruct gender stereotypes;
- Foster, share and apply science and innovation research to different genres of enterprises eg start-ups, SMEs, entrepreneurs;
- Encourage mentoring across the different groups involved in the partnerships in order to take full advantage of science, technology, research and innovation;
- Encourage industry-funded innovation to become part of lifelong learning programmes

Scope: Science education should be an essential component of compulsory education for all students. Policies should support students, teachers, parents and the wider community to improve access to and provide everyone with the opportunities to pursue excellence in learning and learning outcomes and to ensure young people and adult learners alike are motivated to learn and to be fully equipped to engage in scientific discourse and facilitate further study in science education.

The proposed action targets the creation of new partnerships in local communities to foster improved science education for all citizens and to contribute to a learning continuum for all. It seeks to promote partnerships between for example teachers, students, scientists, researchers, innovators, professionals in enterprise and other stakeholders in science related fields to work together on real-life challenges and innovations within local communities with a view to engaging them in teaching and learning processes and to promote science education as part of local community development.

This action aims to support a range of activities based on collaboration at local level between formal, non-formal and informal science education providers, enterprises and civil society in order to integrate the concept of open schooling, including all educational levels, in science education.

The action should consider current policy initiatives. Reference and consideration should be given to previously funded projects. Applicants should develop links with Scientix⁹⁶ and consider links with other policy domains such as projects funded under SwafS-26-2020 (Innovators of the future: bridging the gender gap).

⁹⁶ <https://cordis.europa.eu/project/id/730009>

Currently, Europe faces a shortfall in science-knowledgeable people at all levels of society at a time when it needs ever more scientists and a science literate society. The coronavirus pandemic demonstrates the importance and necessity of having highly qualified scientists, researchers, innovators and medics to keep our society safe and healthy. To increase the uptake of science careers to feed the talent pipeline, and to improve science literacy in our adult population and support a learning continuum for all, a collaborative action on Open Schooling is proposed.

GENDER EQUALITY

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2022-ERA-01-80: Living Lab for gender-responsive innovation

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 3.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 3.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Research and Innovation Actions

Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to the following expected outcomes:

- Advancement of knowledge and practice on gender-responsive innovation in Europe
- Strengthening of the innovation and inclusiveness dimensions of the European Research Area.

Scope: Women remain disproportionately under-represented among innovators and start-up entrepreneurs and hold less than 10% of patent applications⁹⁷, while the integration of the gender dimension into product design, technologies and innovations in general, remains very limited despite its potential for opening new markets and its core importance for solving global challenges and European priorities. Moreover, a positive correlation between the European Innovation Scoreboard and the Gender Equality Index has been reported, and a higher proportion of research organisations with a gender equality plan in a given country is similarly correlated with a higher Innovation Score⁹⁸.

A “Living Lab” will be put in place, gathering innovators as well as social science and gender scholars to investigate and generate new and disruptive ideas to promote women innovators and develop gender-responsive innovation. This novel knowledge and collaboration scheme

⁹⁷ She Figures 2018, DG Research and Innovation, European Commission: https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/she-figures-2018_en

⁹⁸ <https://genderaction.eu/the-higher-a-country-scores-on-gender-equality-the-higher-its-innovation-potential/>